

## Milestones by age

Printable table by area and age for your log, with space for notes.

### Developmental milestones

What to notice by age — calmly and without comparing.

#### What milestones are (and are not)

Milestones are approximate signs of how a child moves, communicates, plays and relates. They are a guide for accompanying — not a race or a test.

Every child has their own pace. Age ranges are averages: arriving a little earlier or later is usually within what is expected. What matters is the trajectory over time, not a single day.

#### A compass, not a ruler

If something worries you, your observation counts. Asking for guidance early does not "label" anyone: it opens doors to supports that make life easier.

#### What to notice, by area

Four areas grow together. This table gives examples of what usually appears and when it helps to talk with a trusted professional.

##### Area · What usually appears · Worth consulting if...

Motor — Holds head up, sits, crawls, walks, handles objects. — By 12 months they do not move about in any way, or the body seems very stiff or very floppy.

Communication — Babbles, points, first words, joins two words. — By 18 months no words used with intent, or no pointing to request or show.

Social & emotional — Smiles, seeks eye contact, shares attention, imitates gestures. — Does not respond to their name, avoids contact, or loses skills they already had.

Cognitive & play — Explores, looks for hidden objects, plays pretend, solves small challenges. — No pretend play by around age 2, or very limited interest in exploring.

#### A signal not to wait on

Losing skills already gained (stopping talking, looking or playing as before) deserves a prompt consultation — without alarm.

## Words that help

### Developmental surveillance

Watching lovingly and continuously how a child grows and learns, at every health check-up.

### Early intervention

A set of supports in the first years that boost development and bonding.

### Trajectory

The direction of progress over time; it matters more than an isolated data point.

### Stimulation

Offering everyday experiences and play that invite exploration, without pressure.